

Chapter 27 - Parting on Bad Terms

Speaking of it, Feng Yue should thank this Miss Wang. If it hadn't been for her little stunt at the company entrance, Feng Yue wouldn't have been able to discover her illness so early.

However, Feng Yue was somewhat surprised. She was certain that in her previous life, she had never encountered this Miss Wang together with Yan Lin at any banquet.

And after her rebirth, things that definitely wouldn't have happened were now bringing the three of them together at this banquet.

Were predetermined events still going to happen in another form?

Feng Yue slowly closed her eyes, her mood plummeting to rock bottom because of this Miss Wang's appearance.

If the things that had happened before would still occur regardless of how she struggled to change them, then was her current struggle even useful?

Yan Lin stood silently to the side, watching Feng Yue's poor complexion with some concern.

Feng Yue knew Yan Lin hadn't left, but she no longer had the energy to deal with her.

The two stayed like this for quite a while. Feng Yue estimated the time and, when she felt it was about right, stood up directly to leave.

Yan Lin didn't say anything more, just silently followed her.

Feng Yue frowned and stopped walking. "Yan Lin, I still want to live a bit longer. I hope you won't appear in front of me again."

After saying this, regardless of whether Yan Lin heard her or not, she returned to the banquet hall.

Yan Lin remained standing dumbly in the small garden, with the spouting fountain behind her and the corridor leading to the banquet hall in front.

But at this moment, Yan Lin felt that neither of these places was where she belonged.

She had been completely shut out of Feng Yue's world.

The cool evening breeze came with the water mist from the fountain. Yan Lin shivered all over. It was early autumn weather, but she felt a chill rising from the soles of her feet.

How Yan Lin finally left this full moon celebration, she had already forgotten. She only remembered Feng Yue's final words.

She wanted to live longer. And her own rash appearance might truly have made the other party feel uncomfortable and annoyed.

Ever since encountering Wang Cuili in the small garden, Feng Yue had been somewhat absent-minded. Seeing her distracted state, Mother Feng thought it was because she had seen Yan Lin, so the couple went to bid farewell to General Manager Wang early.

General Manager Wang was also aware of the news about Feng Yue and Yan Lin's divorce, so he naturally assumed the Feng family was leaving to avoid Yan Lin.

But not long after the Feng family left, Yan Lin also departed.

General Manager Wang watched Yan Lin's departing figure. So this Miss Yan had come here tonight just to see the Feng family's daughter?

It seemed that even though the two had divorced, the relationship between the two families wasn't too strained.

After returning home, Feng Yue went directly to her room. Her mind was in chaos now, and she suddenly felt that all her previous struggles seemed useless. She might still die from illness in a year or so.

Feng Yue lay on her bed. The bedroom lights had been turned off, but she couldn't sleep at all.

But if no matter how things changed, what was meant to happen would still happen, then what about the kidnapping she had helped Dai Shuangshuang avoid back then?

No, that wasn't right.

The kidnapping still happened, but the person kidnapped wasn't Dai Shuangshuang.

The meeting between the three of them still occurred, but this time she had discovered her illness much earlier.

In other words, if her illness was destined to happen, did that mean the result of her "death" was changeable?

Feng Yue felt like she had grasped a little bit of the pattern of how things changed, but her heart still wasn't very certain.

She sighed deeply and turned over, burying herself deep into her pillow.

Forget it, she wouldn't think about it anymore. If she was ultimately destined to die in a year or so, then she should live her current life well.

If she really died, her dad and Mother Jiang¹ would probably be very, very sad.

Should she make a will or something?

Feng Yue's mind wandered with random thoughts. She also knew that getting a second chance wasn't easy, so there was no need to worry about things that hadn't happened yet. Living well in the present was the most important thing.

Thinking this way, Feng Yue gradually let go of her worries. After all, she had already died once—going through it again wouldn't be that big of a deal.

Once Feng Yue figured this out, she quickly fell into sweet dreams.

But Yan Lin's situation wasn't as pleasant as hers.

Yan Lin didn't go home, nor did she return to any of her houses in Yanjing. Instead, she went directly to the hotel that Mo Yixu had booked for her.

The hotel front desk watched as Yan Lin took the elevator upstairs alone, then began chatting with her shift colleague.

"Hey, did you see that woman just now?"

The other person nodded. "I saw her. What about it?"

"Do you know who she is?"

"Who? I don't know her. She's quite pretty though—is she some celebrity?"

The front desk girl shook her head and said mysteriously in a low voice: "There are quite a few office buildings near our hotel, so usually the customers who book rooms are mostly those CEOs who come here on business trips or to discuss partnerships for short periods."

"But that person just now—she booked the hotel for three months straight. And it's the presidential suite on the top floor. Our general manager personally came to receive her at the time."

The other girl opened her mouth in surprise and gasped. "So who exactly is she? With so much money, why doesn't she buy a house? Even renting would be better than staying in a hotel."

The front desk girl smiled mysteriously. "I also heard this secondhand. You know that tallest office building not far from us, right? Have you heard of Yan Corporation?"

"Of course I have!"

"She's that Miss Yan, the current person in power at Yan Corporation."

"Holy shit, should I say she's pitiful or pitiful? So rich but still staying in a hotel—wouldn't buying a house be better?"

"Sigh, we don't understand rich people's thoughts, haha. Maybe like in novels, she was kicked out by family elders or something like that, hahahaha."

"Pfft, you've been reading too many novels."

Yan Lin had no idea what the front desk girls were discussing. She just silently returned to her suite.

After showering, Yan Lin stood in front of the floor-to-ceiling windows in the suite's living room wearing only a bathrobe. She held a lit cigarette between her fingers, but it was merely lit.

Yan Lin was lost in thought about something. After a moment, she picked up her phone and dialed her only friend—Fu Sixue.

The phone rang for a long time before being answered. Fu Sixue's half-dead voice came through.

"Hello, A-Lin, what's wrong..."

Yan Lin seemed startled by her condition and paused before asking: "...Are you okay?"

"Ah, I'm fine. I'm just sacrificing my life for design drafts."

Yan Lin fell silent, seemingly able to picture Fu Sixue's soul leaving her body.

"Wait a moment, let me wash my face to wake up." After saying this, Fu Sixue put down the phone and ran off, not giving Yan Lin a chance to hang up.

Calling this number was somewhat a last resort for Yan Lin. She really didn't know what to do anymore.

She felt like she had been abandoned by Feng Yue on an endless sea surface. Except for the ice beneath her feet that hadn't yet melted, she had nowhere to go.

When the ice melted, she would completely fall into that deep abyss where Feng Yue didn't exist.

She could only seek help from those around her.

Fu Sixue quickly picked up the phone again. "A-Lin, what's wrong? Go ahead and tell me."

Yan Lin pressed her lips together and told Fu Sixue everything that had happened at tonight's full moon celebration in detail.

After listening, Fu Sixue sighed deeply. "Sigh, I'm telling you, why do you keep approaching Little Moon?"

"You two just got divorced recently. How could she possibly have a good attitude toward you? Besides, since she was determined enough to divorce you, she must have given up on you completely."

Fu Sixue went to the refrigerator to get some food while talking. "Moreover, I heard that people who've had serious illnesses can undergo major changes in their thinking, let alone someone like Little Moon with this kind of illness. That's brain cancer—even if it's early stage, it's still a disease where you're snatching life from the Grim Reaper."

Yan Lin gripped her phone tightly, even her voice trembling slightly. "Then what... should I do? I just... don't want her to give up on me..."

Fu Sixue was stunned. This was the first time she had felt such fear and helplessness from Yan Lin.

Fu Sixue scratched her head. To be honest, she had never dealt with getting back together after a breakup, so she really didn't know what to do in this situation.

But if Yan Lin wanted to pursue Feng Yue again, then catering to her preferences should be fine, right?

So what did Feng Yue need most right now?

For Yan Lin to stay away from her.

Fu Sixue nodded secretly to herself, then said into the phone: "You two just got divorced recently. Don't approach Little Moon for now. If you keep hanging around in front of her, she'll probably hate you even more."

Yan Lin was silent for two seconds, then responded dully: "I understand."

Although Yan Lin was very reluctant to admit it, Fu Sixue was right.

Even if she shamelessly pestered Feng Yue now, Feng Yue's impression of her would only get worse. Every time she appeared, Feng Yue would be unhappy...

Yan Lin clearly understood that she should indeed do as Fu Sixue suggested and temporarily leave Feng Yue's sight.

"Thank you." Yan Lin said flatly to her friend on the other end of the phone. "It's late. Rest early."

"Okay—" Fu Sixue drew out her voice, clearly tired.

After hanging up, the only sound in the suite disappeared.

Yan Lin looked at the endless stream of vehicles below and the lights in the distance.

She turned her head to look at the small night light glowing on the bedroom nightstand, and her heart felt much more comforted.

This was something she had specifically asked the hotel to prepare. She thought that during this time away from Feng Yue, she might still need it.

To serve as her substitute for Feng Yue on this dark, endless sea, becoming the only light in her dreams.

Yan Lin silently lay down on the bed. All the lights in the suite dimmed, leaving only the small night light by her bedside still glowing.

Footnotes:

¹ "Mother Jiang" (江女士) - This refers to Feng Yue's mother. In Chinese culture, it's common to refer to someone's mother by their surname followed by "女士" (Ms./Mrs.) as a formal but affectionate way of address.